

SECTION 02 • FIVE PRACTICAL TOOLS

Kids & co-parenting.

Reduce chaos for the kids. Five tools to make the week run better.

IN THIS SECTION

- 04 Handover checklist
- 05 Conversation scripts
- 06 Routine & rhythm
- 07 Shared info snapshot
- 08 Sunday reset

Predictability over perfection.

KIDS & CO-PARENTING • TOOL 04

Handover checklist.

Reduce the invisible chaos. Most handover stress is operational, not emotional — this fixes the operational part.

THIS CHECKLIST HELPS YOU

Stop forgotten essentials

Keep school items packed

Keep medications moving with the kids

Keep comfort items in the right home

Pass useful notes between houses

Lower handover stress for everyone

PAGE 01 • THE PACK-LIST

Run the list. Pack the bag.

Print this. Pin it inside a cupboard door. Run the list as you pack — not from memory. Children settle more easily when practical details are predictable.

01 School essentials

● GOES BACK TOMORROW

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ School uniform. | ☐ School shoes. |
| ☐ Hat. | ☐ Homework. |
| ☐ Laptop or iPad. | ☐ Chargers. |
| ☐ Library books. | ☐ Permission notes signed. |
| ☐ School bag packed. | ☐ Lunch items organised. |

02 Sports & activities

● CHECK THE WEEK

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Sports uniform. | ☐ Sports shoes. |
| ☐ Water bottle. | ☐ Equipment packed. |
| ☐ Musical instruments. | ☐ Dance / activity gear. |
| ☐ Activity schedule checked. | ☐ Transport confirmed. |

03 Health & medication

● DON'T SKIP

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Medication packed and labelled. | ☐ Medical notes updated. |
| ☐ Allergies communicated. | ☐ Specialist appointments noted. |
| ☐ Scripts and refills checked. | |

Small things, settle them.

A favourite blanket and a one-line note about a rough sleep matter more than they look like they do. Keep the comfort layer steady; keep the other house briefly informed.

04 Comfort & routine

● SAME IN BOTH HOMES

☐ Favourite comfort item.	☐ Sleep toy or blanket.
☐ Toiletries.	☐ Pyjamas.
☐ Weekend clothes.	☐ Device chargers.
☐ Special event items packed.	☐ Reading book / current chapter.

05 Notes for the other home

● BRIEF, PRACTICAL, NO DRAMA

School updates

NOTE

NOTE

Behaviour or sleep

NOTE

NOTE

Schedule changes

NOTE

NOTE

Anything else worth knowing

NOTE

NOTE

"The goal is not perfect handovers. The goal is reducing avoidable stress."

ATLAS — FIELD NOTE

KIDS & CO-PARENTING • TOOL 05

Conversation scripts.

Reduce escalation. You do not need to sound perfect. You need to sound steady.

USE THESE TO

Buy thinking time

Keep tone steady

Defuse loaded messages

Stay practical about money

Centre the kids in decisions

Hold a calm boundary

Borrow the tone. Buy the time.

People borrow tone from language. Read these once. Use the phrasing that fits. The goal is not to win the message — it's to keep tonight calmer than it would have been.

01 Schedule changes

BUYING TIME

“Thanks for the message. Let me check the week properly and I'll come back to you tonight.”

CONDITIONAL YES

“That change should be workable. I'll confirm once I check school and transport.”

SOFT NO

“I can't make that switch this week, but I'm happy to look at another option.”

02 Difficult messages

PAUSE THE LOOP

“I don't think this conversation is productive right now. I'm happy to revisit it once things are calmer.”

ACKNOWLEDGE, REDIRECT

“I understand you're frustrated. I'd prefer to focus on the practical issue we need to solve.”

TAKE A BEAT

“I need some time before responding properly.”

Keep numbers visible. Keep kids central.

The two conversations that escalate fastest. Money goes calmer when both of you are looking at the same numbers; parenting decisions go calmer when the kids are the subject, not the weapon.

03 Money conversations

SLOW IT DOWN

“I'd prefer to look at the actual numbers before agreeing to anything.”

SHARED PICTURE

“Let's write down the shared expenses clearly so we're discussing the same information.”

NO QUICK YES

“I'm not comfortable making a quick financial decision today.”

04 Kids & parenting

CENTRE THE CHILDREN

“I think consistency will help them most right now.”

RE-FRAME

“Can we focus on what creates the least disruption for the kids this week?”

PROTECT THE AUDIENCE

“I'd prefer we discuss this without the kids present.”

A boundary is just a repeated sentence.

You don't need a speech. You need one line you can use again next time, and the time after that. Steady beats clever.

05 Boundaries

● REUSABLE

LOGISTICS ONLY

“I'm happy to discuss parenting logistics. I don't want to revisit the relationship discussion right now.”

KEEP IT PRACTICAL

“I'd prefer communication stays focused on the practical issue.”

NOT TONIGHT

“I'm not available to continue this conversation tonight.”

Which conversations repeatedly create stress — and what communication style usually escalates them?

"Clearer communication often lowers conflict before it grows. Borrow the tone. Borrow the line. Use it again."

ATLAS — FIELD NOTE

TOOL 06 • ROUTINE & RHYTHM

Predictability helps them feel safer.

Two homes. One rhythm where possible. Write the routine down so it survives a tired Tuesday — and so the other house can mirror what works.

01 Morning routine

TASK	TIME
Wake up	
Breakfast	
School preparation	
Leave home	

02 Evening routine

TASK	TIME
Dinner	
Homework	
Screens off	
Bedtime	

03 Weekly structure

● BOTH HOMES

DAY	HOME	KEY ACTIVITIES
Monday		
Tuesday		
Wednesday		
Thursday		
Friday		
Saturday		
Sunday		

TOOL 07 • SHARED INFO

Important info, in one place.

Both households work better with the same baseline facts. Fill once, copy to the fridge, update twice a year — or whenever something material changes.

01 School information

● PER CHILD IF NEEDED

ITEM	DETAILS
School name	
Class teacher	
School contact / front office	
Year coordinator	
Pickup arrangements	

02 Medical

ITEM	DETAILS
GP	
Allergies	
Medications	
Specialist	
Emergency contact	

03 Activities

ACTIVITY	DAY / TIME
Sports	
Music	
Tutoring	
Other	
Other	

TOOL 08 • SUNDAY RESET

Reset the week before the week starts.

Fifteen minutes on a Sunday evening saves three small fires on a Tuesday morning. Run the same loop every week.

01 This week's priorities

● ONE LINE EACH

KIDS

SCHOOL

TRANSPORT

ADMIN

MEALS

02 Upcoming events

EVENT

DAY

03 Reset checklist

- ☐ School bags ready.
- ☐ Uniforms washed.
- ☐ Calendar checked.
- ☐ Medication packed.
- ☐ Food organised.
- ☐ Handover times confirmed.
- ☐ Chargers packed.
- ☐ Sports gear ready.

CLOSING — SECTION 02

Steadiness beats dramatic solutions.

Children do not need perfect parents during separation. They benefit most from steadiness, predictability, calmer environments, and reduced operational chaos. Small systems matter more than dramatic solutions.

STEADY

PREDICTABLE

OPERATIONAL

REUSED WEEKLY